

ETEN MENTORSHIP MODULE

Engineering Requirements Document

Product & technical requirements for building the ETEN Mentorship & Capability Accelerator inside the ETEN platform

How to read this document

This document covers the full mentorship roadmap so the platform is architected correctly from day one — but it does not authorise building all of it now. Section 5 is the only build request today. Sections 8 and 9 describe later phases so the data model and screens don't need to be rebuilt later; they are context, not a sprint backlog.

Prepared for: Expervia Engineering Team

Based on: ETEN Mentorship & Capability Accelerator Framework v1.0 (9 September 2026); ETEN/Expervia Commercialization Engine & Monetization Playbook v1.3; ETEN Pod Leader Role & Responsibility Framework

Version: 1.0 — For Engineering Scoping and Estimation

Date: 9 September 2026

Status: Ready for technical review; data model is a proposed starting point, not a locked schema

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1. Purpose and Build Priority

This document translates the approved ETEN Mentorship & Capability Accelerator Framework into requirements engineering can estimate and build against. It covers three build horizons so the architecture doesn't have to be reworked as scope expands, but only one of them is an active build request:

Horizon	Status	What this means for engineering
Phase 1 — Mentorship Circles (Section 5)	BUILD NOW	Fully specified: user flows, screens, functional requirements, acceptance criteria and data model. Scope this and estimate it.
Phase 2 — 1:1, Project Mentorship, paid Circles (Section 8)	DESIGN FOR, DO NOT BUILD	Architect Phase 1 so these extend it without a rewrite. No screens or sprints against this yet.
Phase 3+ — Marketplace, Mentor Score, Executive tier, Reverse Mentorship (Section 9)	AWARENESS ONLY	Directional only, so naming and data structures aren't painted into a corner. Not being requested.

Business rationale for this phasing — and the evidence-based conditions that trigger each later phase — are documented in the Framework's Section 9 ("What We Are Deferring, and Why"). Engineering should treat those unlock conditions, not feature requests, as the signal to start Phase 2 or 3 work.

2. System Context — Integration with the Existing ETEN Platform

The mentorship module is not a new application. It is a module inside the existing ETEN platform (as defined in the Playbook's Product Blueprint, Section 11) and must reuse existing identity, pod, verification and evidence infrastructure rather than duplicating it.

Existing ETEN module	What Mentorship reads from it	What Mentorship writes to it
Member Identity / Profile	Member ID, name, contact, current V-level, technology specialisation	Nothing — mentorship never creates or edits core identity fields
Pods	Pod membership roster (who belongs to which capability cell)	Nothing — Circle membership is a separate, mentorship-owned join, not a change to pod membership
Verification Desk / Commercial Readiness Panel	Existing credential and practical-assessment evidence used to support a Mentor Candidate application	Mentor verification decision (Candidate → Verified Mentor and mentor-level changes)
Portfolio / Proof Builder (capability passport)	Nothing	Evidence records — session completion, assignment sign-off — attributed to the mentee's existing capability passport
Expert Score / Recognition	Nothing	Score credit and badge triggers for mentors and mentees on defined milestones
Hard constraint Do not create a second user table, a second verification workflow, or a second scoring system for mentorship. Every entity below either extends an existing ETEN entity or references it by ID.		

3. User Roles and Permissions

Role	Who	Can do
Mentee	Any ETEN member, typically V0–V4	● View own mentorship record and progress ● Set one structured goal (target V-level + capability) ● View assigned Circle, sessions and assignments ● Submit assignment evidence
Mentor	V2+ member approved as Verified Mentor	● View own Circle(s) and mentee roster ● Log session attendance ● Review and sign off assignment evidence ● See own Mentor level and badge status
Pod Leader	Existing ETEN Pod Leader role	● Nominate Mentor Candidates from their pod ● Create a Circle and assign a Verified Mentor + up to 10 mentees from their pod roster ● View Circle progress across their pod
Verification Desk / Readiness Panel	Existing ETEN governance role	● Review Mentor Candidate evidence ● Approve/reject mentor verification and mentor-level changes
Academy Lead	Existing ETEN role	Publish Circle curriculum templates and assignment content used across cells
Platform Admin	Engineering / Ops	Configure capability cells, V-level taxonomy references, badge rules

4. Phase 1 (Build Now) — Mentorship Circles

This is the only section that constitutes an active build request.

4.1 Scope Statement

- One format only: Mentorship Circles — one Verified Mentor supervising 5–10 mentees, run inside an existing Pod.
- Mentor Candidacy is nominated by a Pod Leader and approved by the existing Verification Desk / Readiness Panel — no new verification workflow.
- Circle formation is manual — Pod Leaders assemble a Circle from their own roster. No automated or algorithmic matching.
- A mentee's goal is a single structured field: target V-level plus capability area, selected from the existing taxonomy — not a free-text goal builder.
- Session attendance, assignment completion and mentor sign-off are logged as evidence and written to the mentee's existing capability passport.
- Recognition only: mentor badge and Expert Score credit on defined completion milestones. No payment or invoicing logic in Phase 1.

4.2 Core User Flows

Flow A — Mentor verification

- Pod Leader nominates a V2+ pod member as a Mentor Candidate.
- System notifies the Verification Desk / Readiness Panel with the candidate's existing credential and assessment evidence attached.
- Panel approves (candidate becomes Verified Mentor) or rejects, with a reason code recorded.

Flow B — Circle creation and mentee enrolment

- Pod Leader creates a Circle: selects a Verified Mentor and up to 10 mentees from the pod roster.
- Each enrolled mentee sets their goal (target V-level + capability area).
- Circle is scheduled against a cadence (weekly or biweekly) for a fixed duration (default 6–8 weeks, configurable).

Flow C — Running a Circle

- Mentor logs each session: date, attendance per mentee, topic/notes.
- Mentor (or Academy-provided template) posts an assignment; mentees submit evidence (text, link or file).
- Mentor reviews submitted evidence and signs off (approve / needs revision).
- Approved evidence is written to the mentee's capability passport with a reference back to the Circle and mentor.

Flow D — Completion and recognition

- Circle reaches its scheduled end date or Pod Leader marks it complete.
- System evaluates completion criteria per mentee (see acceptance criteria) and, where met, triggers Expert Score credit and a Mentee badge.
- Mentor receives a completion record; where mentor-level criteria (Section 6) are met, mentor level is eligible for review.

4.3 Screens Required

Screen	Role	Purpose
Nominate Mentor	Pod Leader	Select a pod member, submit as Mentor Candidate
Mentor Candidate Queue	Verification Desk / Readiness Panel	Review evidence, approve/reject candidates
Create Circle	Pod Leader	Select mentor, select mentees, set cadence and duration
Circle Roster & Progress	Pod Leader	View all Circles in their pod and mentee-level progress
Mentor Dashboard	Mentor	Active Circle(s), mentee list, session log, assignment review queue, mentor level/badges
My Mentorship (Mentee view)	Mentee	Goal, current V-level, target V-level, mentor, session schedule, outstanding tasks, evidence submitted

4.4 Functional Requirements

1. The system shall allow a Pod Leader to nominate any V2+ member of their own pod as a Mentor Candidate.
2. The system shall route a Mentor Candidate nomination to the Verification Desk / Readiness Panel queue and record the resulting decision (approved, rejected, reason).
3. The system shall prevent a member from being assigned as a Circle mentor unless their status is Verified Mentor or above.
4. The system shall allow a Pod Leader to create a Circle with one mentor and between 1 and 10 mentees, all drawn from members of that Pod Leader's own pod.
5. The system shall require each enrolled mentee to select a target V-level and capability area before the Circle is marked active.
6. The system shall allow a mentor to log session attendance per mentee per scheduled session.
7. The system shall allow a mentor to post an assignment to all mentees in a Circle, and allow each mentee to submit evidence against it.
8. The system shall allow a mentor to approve or request revision on submitted evidence, with approved evidence written to the mentee's existing capability passport, tagged with the Circle ID and mentor ID.
9. The system shall compute and display, per mentee, a simple progress indicator based on sessions attended and assignments approved out of the Circle total.
10. The system shall trigger a defined Expert Score credit and badge for a mentee when Circle completion criteria (Section 4.5) are met, and shall record a completion event against the mentor.
11. The system shall restrict visibility of Circle data to the assigned mentor, the enrolled mentees (own record only) and the owning Pod Leader.

4.5 Acceptance Criteria

- A Pod Leader can nominate a Mentor Candidate and see the nomination's status change once the Verification Desk decides.
- A Verified Mentor can only be assigned to a Circle after verification is recorded — the system rejects assignment attempts before that.
- A Pod Leader can create a Circle with a named mentor and mentee list drawn only from their own pod; the system blocks selecting members outside that pod.
- Every enrolled mentee has a recorded target V-level and capability area before the Circle can be activated.
- A mentor can log attendance and review assignment evidence for every mentee in their Circle(s).
- Approved evidence appears on the mentee's existing capability passport, correctly attributed to the Circle and mentor.
- A mentee who meets the defined completion threshold receives the Expert Score credit and badge automatically, without manual intervention.
- One pilot Circle can be run end-to-end per initial capability cell (Modern Work, Data & AI, Business Applications) using only the screens and flows above.

4.6 Explicitly Out of Scope for Phase 1

- Automated or algorithmic mentor-mentee matching.
- Mentor search, filtering or a public mentor directory ("Mentor Marketplace").
- Any payment, invoicing or payout mechanism for mentors.

- 1:1 Mentorship, Project Mentorship and Executive Mentorship formats.
- Mentor Score algorithm or any automated mentor ranking.
- Reverse mentorship.
- Corporate, university or sponsored programme tooling.

5. Proposed Data Model

A starting point for engineering, not a locked schema. Entities marked "extends existing" must reference the existing ETEN entity by ID rather than duplicating its fields.

5.1 Core entities (Phase 1)

Entity	Key fields	Relationships / notes
MentorProfile	• member_id (FK to existing Member) • mentor_status: candidate verified senior expert master • verified_at, verified_by (Readiness Panel reviewer) • capability_cell(s)	Extends the existing Member entity — does not duplicate identity fields. One MentorProfile per Member.
MentorNomination	• member_id (FK) • nominated_by (Pod Leader ID) • status: pending approved rejected • decision_reason • decided_by, decided_at	Feeds MentorProfile.mentor_status on approval.
MentorshipCircle	• circle_id • pod_id (FK to existing Pod) • mentor_id (FK to MentorProfile) • capability_cell • cadence: weekly biweekly • start_date, end_date • status: draft active completed	Owned by the Pod Leader who created it; pod_id constrains eligible mentees.
CircleMembership	• circle_id (FK) • member_id (FK) • target_v_level • target_capability • enrolled_at • status: active completed withdrawn	One row per mentee per Circle. Holds the mentee's single structured goal.
Session	• session_id • circle_id (FK) • session_date • notes	One row per scheduled Circle session.
Attendance	• session_id (FK) • member_id (FK) • attended: boolean	Join table between Session and mentee.

Entity	Key fields	Relationships / notes
Assignment	• assignment_id • circle_id (FK) • title • instructions • due_date	Posted by the mentor, optionally sourced from an Academy template.
EvidenceSubmission	• submission_id • assignment_id (FK) • member_id (FK) • content_ref (text/link/file) • status: submitted approved needs_revision • reviewed_by, reviewed_at	On approval, writes a reference into the existing Portfolio/Proof Builder evidence log — does not replace it.
RecognitionEvent	• event_id • member_id (FK) • type: mentee_badge mentor_badge score_credit • circle_id (FK) • triggered_at	Feeds the existing Expert Score / badge system; mentorship does not maintain its own score store.

5.2 What Phase 1 deliberately does not model

- No payment, rate or payout fields anywhere in the schema — added only when Phase 2 is authorised.
- No matching-score, ranking or search-index fields — added only when Phase 3 is authorised.
- No separate mentor rating/review entity in Phase 1 — qualitative feedback, if needed, can live as free text on RecognitionEvent until a scoring model is approved.

6. Mentor Levels (Reference)

Mentor level changes are a Verification Desk / Readiness Panel decision, not an automated computation, but the thresholds below should inform what data the panel needs visibility into.

Level	Data the Panel needs to see
Mentor Candidate	Nomination record, existing V-status and credential evidence
Verified Mentor	Approved MentorNomination
Senior Mentor	At least one completed Circle with recorded mentee progression
Expert Mentor	Multiple completed Circles; consistent mentee completion; member's own V4+ status
ETEN Master Mentor	Sustained Circle outcomes plus any recorded leadership evidence

7. Non-Functional Requirements

Area	Requirement
Identity & auth	Reuse the existing ETEN authentication and Member identity system. No separate login for mentors or mentees.
Access control	Pod Leaders see only their own pod's Circles; mentors see only their own Circle(s); mentees see only their own record.
Auditability	Mentor verification decisions and evidence approvals must be logged with reviewer identity and timestamp — this data ultimately supports commercial-readiness evidence.
Consent & privacy	Mentee and mentor participation follows ETEN's existing membership-terms and data-consent framework; no new consent flow unless legal advises otherwise.
Notifications	Basic session reminders and assignment-due notifications (email or existing in-app channel) are sufficient for Phase 1 — no dedicated notification engine required.
Extensibility	Schema and screens should not hardcode Circle-only assumptions (e.g. fixed 5–10 mentee range, group-only sessions) in shared logic that Phase 2 formats will reuse.

8. Phase 2 (Design For, Do Not Build) — 1:1, Project and Paid Circles

Not an active build request. Included so Phase 1's architecture doesn't require a rewrite when this phase is authorised — trigger conditions are in the Framework, Section 9.

Change	Impact on Phase 1 design
1:1 Mentorship and Project Mentorship formats	MentorshipCircle generalises to a MentorshipEngagement entity with a format field (circle one_to_one project) and a variable participant count instead of a fixed 5–10 range
Paid Circles / facilitation fees	A new PaymentRecord entity referencing MentorshipEngagement; no changes required to Session, Assignment or EvidenceSubmission
Project supervision	Assignment/EvidenceSubmission extend to support a supervised deliverable and sign-off rather than only session-based assignments

9. Phase 3+ (Awareness Only) — Marketplace, Mentor Score, Executive Tier, Reverse Mentorship

Directional only. Not being requested. Listed so naming and data structures don't need to be redesigned later.

- Mentor Marketplace — a searchable, self-serve mentor directory with filters (technology, goal, experience, availability, language, geography); needs a MentorListing/search-index layer on top of MentorProfile.
- Mentor Score — an algorithmic composite score; needs an outcome-aggregation layer reading from RecognitionEvent, EvidenceSubmission and completed MentorshipEngagements once sufficient outcome history exists.
- Executive / Leadership Mentorship — a premium engagement type layered onto MentorshipEngagement once Phase 2's format field exists.
- Reverse Mentorship — the same MentorshipEngagement model with mentor/mentee roles reversible per engagement rather than fixed.

10. Open Questions for Engineering

- Does the existing Pod entity already expose a queryable roster suitable for the Circle-creation screen, or does this need a new read model?
- Does the existing Portfolio/Proof Builder have a defined API/contract for writing third-party-sourced evidence (as opposed to member-submitted evidence), or does one need to be added?
- Does the existing Expert Score system accept externally triggered credit events, or does mentorship need to compute and push a delta?
- Should EvidenceSubmission support file uploads in Phase 1, or is a link/text reference sufficient for the pilot?
- What is the right home for Circle scheduling — a simple date/cadence field (proposed here) or integration with an existing calendar tool already in use by Pods or Academy?

11. Suggested Delivery Milestones (Phase 1)

Milestone	Scope
M1	Data model implemented; Mentor nomination and verification flow (Flow A)
M2	Circle creation and mentee enrolment (Flow B)
M3	Session logging, assignments and evidence sign-off, writing to the capability passport (Flow C)
M4	Mentor Dashboard and My Mentorship (mentee) screens
M5	Completion and recognition triggers (Flow D)
Pilot	One Circle run end-to-end per initial capability cell (Modern Work, Data & AI, Business Applications), timed to the next commercial-readiness sprint

12. References

- ETEN Mentorship & Capability Accelerator Framework v1.0 (9 September 2026) — business rationale, phasing discipline, deferral conditions.

- ETEN/Expervia Commercialization Engine & Monetization Playbook v1.3 — Product Blueprint (Section 11), Member Journey (Section 12), Verification Framework (Task 2.3).
- ETEN Pod Leader Role & Responsibility Framework — Pod Leader responsibilities and the V0-V5 readiness model.